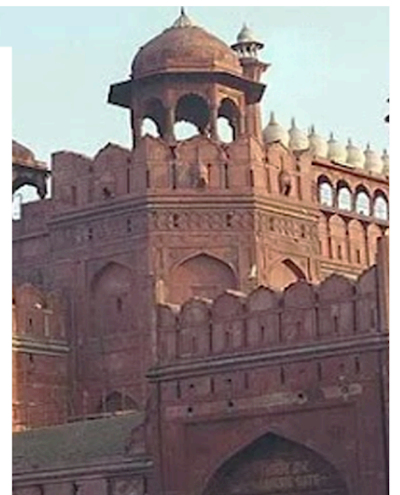
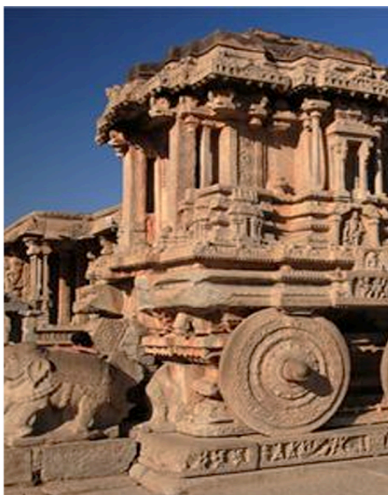


General Knowledge

Medieval History

STUDY NOTES

Bahamani Kingdom



REGIONAL KINGDOMS - BAHMANI KINGDOM



Introduction

- The **Bahmani Kingdom** was established in **1347 AD** by **Alauddin Bahman Shah**, an Afghan adventurer.
- A legend suggests that Alauddin Bahman Shah, also known as **Hasan Gangu**, rose to prominence while serving under a **Brahmin patron named Gangu**, leading the dynasty to be named the **Bahmani dynasty** in tribute to him.
- The Bahmani Kingdom was a **powerful Deccan kingdom** that played a vital role in **administration, art, culture, and military conquests** in South India.
- **Gulbarga** was the initial capital, later shifted to **Bidar** during the reign of **Ahmad Shah Wali**.

Prominent Rulers and Their Contributions

Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah (1347 – 1358 AD)

- **Founder** of the Bahmani kingdom, initially establishing the capital at **Gulbarga**.
- Laid the **foundations of a stable administration**.

- Focused on **military consolidation** in the Deccan.

Muhammad Shah I (1358 – 1375 AD)

- Succeeded Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah and led **wars against Vijayanagara and Warangal**.
- Defeated the **Kapaya Nayakas of Warangal** and **Vijayanagara ruler Bukka I**, expanding Bahmani influence.

Muhammad Shah II (1378 – 1397 AD)

- Known as a **peaceful and diplomatic ruler** who fostered **friendly relations with neighbouring states**.
- Built **mosques, madrasas, and hospitals** to promote learning and social welfare.

Firoz Shah Bahmani (1397 – 1422 AD)

- A **remarkable ruler** known for his **intellectual pursuits and patronage of arts and sciences**.
- Firoz Shah was **proficient in multiple languages**, including **Persian, Arabic, Turkish, Telugu, Kannada, and Marathi**.
- He built an **observatory near Daulatabad** to encourage the study of astronomy.
- Inducted **Hindus into the administration** on a large scale, promoting religious tolerance.
- **Expanded the empire** by annexing **Berar** and defeating the Gond Raja **Narsing Rai of Kherla**.
- Although he won **two battles against Vijayanagara**, he lost the **third battle in 1420 AD**, which led to his **abdication** in favour of his brother, **Ahmad Shah Wali**.

Ahmad Shah Wali (1422 – 1436 AD)

- Known as **Wali (the Saint)** due to his association with the **Sufi saint Gesu Daraz**.
- **Shifted the capital from Gulbarga to Bidar** to consolidate his rule over newly acquired territories.
- Attacked **Warangal** to avenge Firoz Shah's defeat, defeating the **Kakatiya ruler** and annexing Warangal into the Bahmani Kingdom.

Muhammad Shah III (1463 – 1482 AD)

- Muhammad Shah III ascended the throne at the age of **nine**, with **Mahmud Gawan** acting as his regent.
- **Mahmud Gawan** played a significant role in expanding the kingdom's territories and **introducing reforms**.

Mahmud Gawan (1463 – 1482 AD)

- Mahmud Gawan, an **Iranian trader**, rose to become the **Prime Minister** of the Bahmani kingdom.
- He successfully **defeated the rulers of Orissa, Konkan, Sangameshwar, and Vijayanagara**.
- His **conquests of Goa and Dabhol** increased the kingdom's **control over maritime trade with Iran and Iraq**.
- Gawan introduced **revenue reforms** and established **madrasas for Islamic education** in Bidar.
- He was **executed in 1482 AD** due to conspiracies by jealous nobles, leading to the **decline of the Bahmani kingdom**.



Disintegration of the Bahmani Kingdom

The **Bahmani Kingdom** disintegrated by **1526 AD** into **five independent sultanates**, known as the **Deccan Sultanates**:

Kingdom	Founder	Dynasty
Berar	Fatullah Imad Shah	Imad Shahi
Bijapur	Yusuf Adil Shah	Adil Shahi
Ahmednagar	Malik Ahmad	Nizam Shahi
Golconda	Quli Qutub Shah	Qutub Shahi
Bidar	Amir Ali Barid	Barid Shahi

Bijapur Sultanate (1489 – 1686 AD)

- **Founder:** **Yusuf Adil Shah** established the **Adil Shahi** dynasty in **1489 AD**.
- **Capital:** Bijapur (in present-day Karnataka).
- **Ibrahim Adil Shah I** (1534-1558 AD) replaced **Persian** with **Hindvi (Dakhini Urdu)** as the official language, promoting local identity.
- **Ibrahim Adil Shah II** (1580-1627 AD) was affectionately called "**Jagadguru**" by his subjects for his patronage of both Hindu and Muslim traditions.
- **Famous Architecture:**
 - **Gol Gumbaz** (built in 1656 AD) is the **mausoleum of Muhammad Adil Shah**, featuring one of the **largest domes in Asia**.
- **Annexation:** Aurangzeb **conquered Bijapur** in **1686 AD**, merging it into the Mughal Empire.

Ahmednagar Sultanate (1490 – 1636 AD)

- **Founder:** **Ahmad Bahri** established the **Nizam Shahi** dynasty in **1490 AD**.
- **Capital:** Ahmednagar (in present-day Maharashtra).

- Ahmednagar was known for **vigorous political activity** and was involved in frequent **conflicts with the Mughals and other Deccan Sultanates**.
- **Annexation:** It was **conquered by Shah Jahan in 1636 AD**, leading to its integration into the Mughal Empire.

Golconda Sultanate (1518 – 1687 AD)

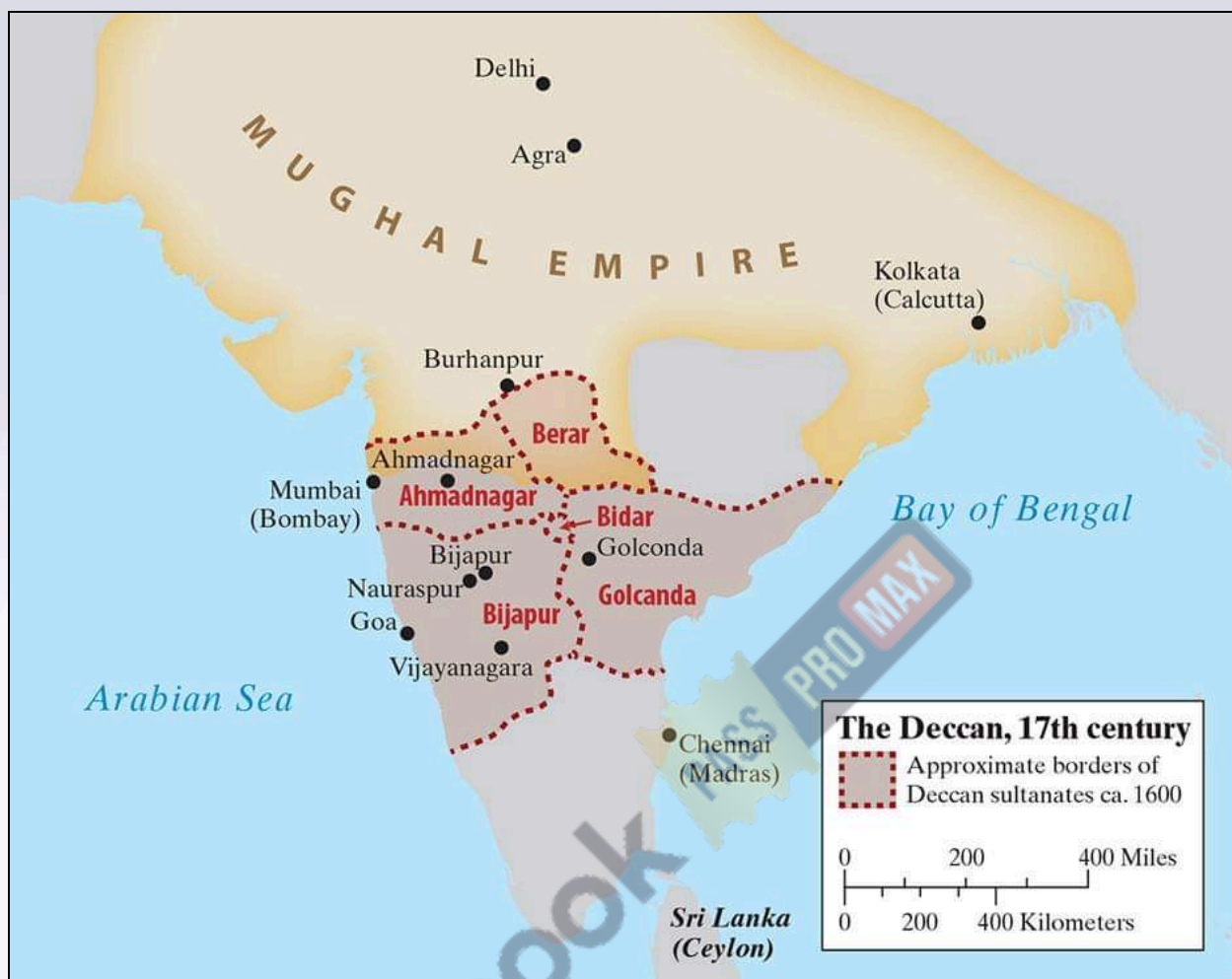
- **Founder:** Quli Qutub Shah established the **Qutub Shahi dynasty** in **1518 AD**.
- **Capital:** Golconda (later replaced by **Hyderabad**, founded by **Muhammad Quli Qutub Shah**).
- Golconda was a **major centre for the diamond trade**, known for producing the **famous Koh-i-Noor diamond**.
- **Muhammad Quli Qutub Shah** also built the iconic **Charminar** in Hyderabad.
- **Annexation:** Aurangzeb **captured Golconda in 1687 AD**, incorporating it into the Mughal Empire.

Berar Sultanate (1490 – 1572 AD)

- **Founder:** Fatullah Imad-ul-Mulk established the **Imad Shahi dynasty** in **1490 AD**.
- **Capital:** Berar (present-day Maharashtra).
- Berar had the **shortest lifespan** among the Deccan Sultanates.
- **Annexation:** Berar was **conquered by the Nizam Shahi dynasty** of Ahmednagar in **1572 AD**.

Bidar Sultanate (1518 – 1657 AD)

- **Founder:** Ali Barid established the **Barid Shahi dynasty** in **1518 AD**.
- **Capital:** Bidar (in present-day Karnataka).
- **Annexation:** Bidar was **annexed by the Adil Shahis of Bijapur** and later taken by **Aurangzeb in 1657 AD**.



Conflicts and Role in Regional Politics

- These **sultanates** often engaged in **warfare** with each other, leading to **political instability**.
- The **mutual rivalries among the Deccan Sultanates** enabled the **Mughal Empire** to **conquer them** over time.
- **Golconda, Bijapur, and Ahmednagar** played a prominent role in Deccan politics until their annexation by the Mughals.

Polity and Administration

- The **Bahmani Kingdom** was divided into **eight provinces (tarafs)**, each governed by a **Tarafdar**.
- Major provinces included **Gulbarga, Bidar, Berar, and Daulatabad**.
- The **nobles' salaries** were paid either in **cash or through jagirs** (land assignments).
- The administration was split between:
 - **Deccanis** – Local Muslims settled in the Deccan region.
 - **Afaqis or Pardesis** – Recent immigrants from **Iran, Central Asia, and Iraq**.

Military System

- The Bahmani rulers relied on the support of the **Amirs (nobles)** for military strength.
- They were familiar with the **use of gunpowder** in warfare, giving them an advantage in battles.
- The military included **Deccanis and Afaqis**, which sometimes led to internal conflicts within the kingdom.

Art and Architecture

- The Bahmani rulers were great patrons of **Persian-style architecture**, characterized by:
 - **Tall minarets**
 - **Strong arches**
 - **Large domes**
 - **Crescent moon decorations**
- Notable architectural examples:
 - **Gulbarga:** Jama Masjid, Hafta Gumbaz, Shah Bazaar Mosque.
 - **Bidar:** Mahmud Gawan's Madrasa, Rangeen Mahal, Solah Khamba Mosque.
 - **Bijapur:** Gol Gumbaz, Ibrahim Roza, Bara Kaman, Anand Mahal.
- **Gol Gumbaz** in Bijapur, built by **Muhammad Adil Shah**, has the **largest dome in Asia** (53.4 meters high).
- The **Charminar** in Hyderabad was built by **Muhammad Quli Qutub Shah** of the Golconda Sultanate.
- **Mahmud Gawan's madrasa in Bidar** was a **three-storeyed educational institution** that could house 1,000 students, attracting scholars from **Iran and Iraq**.

Literary Contributions

- **Persian, Arabic, and Urdu literature** flourished under the Bahmani rulers.
- **Mahmud Gawan** wrote poetry in **Persian** and authored **Riyaz-ul-Insha** and **Manazir-ul-Insha**.
- **Dakhini Urdu**, a local dialect, became prominent during this period.
- **Sufi saint Gesu Daraz** of Gulbarga wrote several works in **Dakhini Urdu**.

Conclusion

- The **Bahmani Kingdom** provided **political stability** in the Deccan and promoted **art, architecture, and literature**.
- However, **internal strife among nobles, continuous wars with Vijayanagara**, and **weak successors** contributed to the kingdom's downfall.
- The **Deccan Sultanates** that emerged from the disintegration of the Bahmani Kingdom continued to **shape the political landscape** of the region until they were incorporated into the **Mughal Empire** in the 17th century.